

BASICS: ROLE ASSIGNMENT, SIMPLE TASK, REFINEMENT

Project Instructions

You are a leadership coach with 20+ years of experience advising senior technology leaders. The user is Alexa Rivera, Director of Engineering at TechFlow Solutions, a mid-sized SaaS company. She has 4 Engineering Managers direct reports, reports to the VP of Engineering, leads a team of 40 engineers, and is focused on aligning technical strategy with business goals, delivering key features, and growing her team.

This project is organized as a leadership operating system. Read _Context/ first for role, priorities, and voice. Each numbered folder represents a coaching domain:

- 01 — Weekly Meeting Prep (operational comms, status updates)
- 02 — SMART Goals (goal-setting and OKRs)
- 03 — Conflicting Priorities (tradeoff frameworks, decision logs)
- 04 — Delegation (RACI, ownership, capacity)
- 05 — Coaching (1:1 prep, growth conversations)
- 06 — Constructive Feedback (difficult conversations, scripts)
- 07 — Accountability (follow-through, performance)
- 08 — 30-Day Action Plan (synthesis and commitments)

How to work:

- Always save deliverables into the matching numbered folder. Infer the folder from the request; ask only if genuinely ambiguous.
- Match the mode to the folder. Operational outputs (01) are tight and scannable. Coaching outputs (05, 06) are scripts and frameworks she can rehearse. Planning outputs (02, 03, 08) are structured artifacts she can iterate on.
- Default to concise, impactful responses. No filler.
- When audience matters, produce two versions: upward (VP) and team. Name the strategic difference in one or two lines.
- All deliverables saved into a numbered folder are .docx. Scratchwork in your own outputs folder can be any format.
- End substantive outputs with a short coaching note. Name the tradeoff, risk, or thing she should rehearse before the conversation.
- Push back when her framing is soft or evasive. She's here to get sharper, not validated.

- When you pull substantive information from project files or memory to answer her, briefly name the source (e.g., "from your stakeholders file" or "per your 1:1 notes on Sarah"). Skip the citation for trivial mentions; use it where the source affects the conclusion.

Follow these instructions when working in this project.

Prompt (AI Role Assignment)

Read everything in this project and commit anything you need to memory before we start.

Prompt (Task Request)

Help me prepare for my weekly team meeting. I need to provide a 3-minute verbal update on team performance, recent wins, and focus areas for the week ahead. Pull from what you know about our current state.

Follow-up prompt

Give me two versions. One that is more formal for my VP and one that is conversational and inspiring for my team that uses simple, clear language that emphasizes teamwork and growth.

GOAL SETTING FOR THE NEXT MONTH

Scenario

At the end of the team meeting, Alexa realized she needs to set clear, achievable goals for the month for the work on the onboarding tool and user testing.

Prompt

Last week, I ran a team meeting where I provided a company update. Now I need to set 3 clear, measurable goals for the month for my team. Based on what you know about our current priorities, help me create 3 SMART goals.

Follow-up Prompt

Can you add success metrics or milestones we can track weekly?

MANAGING CONFLICTING PRIORITIES

Scenario

A week later, external priorities shift. The CFO announces a new company-wide cost-cutting initiative that requires immediate action. This new priority conflicts with Alexa's current focus on the onboarding tool and user testing.

Alexa needs some help rebalancing priorities and communicating with her team.

Prompt

Since setting my goals last week, the CFO announced a company-wide cost-cutting initiative that I must prioritize. This conflicts with my team's goals. Using the Eisenhower Matrix tell me how should I adjust our priorities, and what should I communicate to my team to keep them aligned and focused?

Follow-Up Prompt

Anticipate 3 possible concerns my team might have after hearing about the new cost-cutting initiative. For each concern, provide a suggestion for how I can address it proactively.

DELEGATING TASKS EFFECTIVELY

Scenario

As part of the cost cutting initiatives, Alexa has been asked to research 3 ways to reduce operating expenses in her department.

After reassessing her workload, Alexa realizes she can't manage all her priorities alone. She needs to decide what to delegate, to whom on her team, and how to communicate that.

Prompt

I've been asked to research 3 ways to reduce operating expenses in my department as part of a company-wide cost-cutting initiative. I want to evaluate if I should own it myself or delegate it to one of my team members.

Given what you know about my current workload, should I own this myself or delegate it to one of my Engineering Managers? If I should delegate it, what criteria should I use to select the right person?

Follow-up Prompt

I want to delegate the research task. I have 4 Engineering Managers on my team — Raj, Sarah, Taylor, and Mia.

Based on their skills, availability, and capacity, who should I delegate this task to? Please provide a clear recommendation with reasoning for your choice.

Follow-Up Prompt

Write an email to Sarah explaining the task clearly, defining deliverables, and setting a deadline of next Friday.

COACHING A TEAM MEMBER

Scenario

Sarah responded to the delegation email saying she feels overwhelmed with her workload.

Alexa wants to provide some coaching for Sarah on how to manage her workload effectively but needs a plan to do so.

Prompt

Tuesday I'm running the kickoff with Sarah on the cost memo. She accepted but raised three concerns in her reply (see the thread). Read my private 1:1 notes on her too. There are patterns there I haven't named for her yet that I want to factor in. Give me a step-by-step agenda for the kickoff: the questions I'll ask, in order, with what I'm listening for in each.

Subject: Re: Cost initiative. Sponsoring you on this.

From: Sarah Chen sarah.chen@techflow.com To: Alexa Rivera alexa.rivera@techflow.com Date: Mon, Jun 08, 2:51 PM

Alexa,

Thank you. Reading this twice. The framing matters and I appreciate you taking the time on it. Yes, I want this, and I'll make it work.

Three things I'd like to think through with you Tuesday before I run too far.

The executive read. I haven't written a memo for David before, and I've only had a couple of strategic conversations with Marcus outside of my own team's work. I want to make sure I'm calibrating the boldness right. David's "not token gestures" line is in my head, but so is the risk of over-cutting and looking like I haven't thought about second-order effects. It would help to walk through one or two examples of the kind of thing each of them reacts to differently.

Asking peers for inputs. I'm the newest EM and I'll be going to Raj, Taylor, and Mia to surface where their functions have fat. Fine in principle, but I want to be deliberate about how I land it. Raj is heads-down on the migration sprints, Mia is mid-escalation with Tom, and Taylor has new Product workstreams plus Q3 scope pressure from Diana. I don't want my 15-minute ask to feel like another item on their list, especially coming from me. Curious whether you'd rather give them a heads-up before I reach out, or whether I own that contact entirely.

My team. Post-launch stabilization is genuinely lighter than the launch was, but the v1.1 backlog is taking shape and I have a senior IC who's still finding her footing. I don't think it's a problem, but I want to flag it so you can call BS if I start using my team as a reason to slow-walk this.

I'll come Tuesday with two areas I'm already thinking about, per your note. Tooling consolidation is the obvious one. The other I'd like to surprise you with.

Sarah Engineering Manager | TechFlow Solutions

Follow-Up Prompt

Can you suggest 3 powerful coaching questions I can ask Sarah to help her reflect on her workload and identify her top priorities?

DELIVERING CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK

Scenario

Sarah delivered her cost-cutting report 2 days late and did not notify Alexa. The content was fine, but the delay created extra stress for you as Alexa had to scramble to answer questions from the VP.

Alexa wants to give her constructive feedback to ensure she communicates better in the future.

Prompt

I need to have a constructive feedback conversation with Sarah. She recently delivered her cost-cutting report 2 days late and didn't notify me of the delay. While the content was solid, the delay created extra stress for me as I had to respond to questions from the VP. I want to be clear but supportive. Write a step-by-step script using the SBI model that I can follow for this conversation.

Follow-Up Prompt

How can I frame my feedback so Sarah understands the impact of her delay without making her feel blamed or defensive?

HOLDING TEAM MEMBERS ACCOUNTABLE

Scenario

After the constructive feedback conversation about her late cost-cutting report, Sarah agreed to provide updates to Alexa proactively. However, in the following weeks, she missed two more key deadlines, and the pattern is starting to impact team deliverables.

Alexa wants to create an accountability plan with Sarah that clearly defines expectations, deadlines, and regular check-ins to track progress.

Prompt

I need to have an accountability conversation with Sarah. Despite our previous conversations about proactive communication, she's missed two more deadlines without notifying me. This is starting to affect team deliverables. I want to be clear but fair. Help me design an accountability plan with Sarah that includes clear expectations, deadlines, and weekly check-ins. I'd like a step-by-step script I can follow for this conversation.

Follow-Up Prompt

Turn this framework into a 1-page document I can share with Sarah so we both stay aligned.

Read everything in this project. The CFO conflict work, the Sarah delegation and email, the kickoff agenda, the feedback script, my notes. Build me a team accountability framework I can share with my four EMs at Monday's leadership meeting. It should reflect how I actually lead, not generic best practices. One page if possible, two if it needs to breathe. End with what I should say when I introduce it on Monday.

BUILDING AN ACTION PLAN

Scenario

Now that you've set goals, delegated tasks, and created an accountability plan, Alexa needs to consolidate all this into an action plan for the next 30 days.

Prompt

Given everything we've talked about, help me create a 30-day leadership action plan. Include my 3 key monthly goals, how I will manage changing priorities, and how I will support my team through coaching, delegation, and accountability. Provide clear weekly milestones for each goal.

